07-15 第1篇

阅读理解（说明文）

Why Do We Yawn?

① Have you ever wondered why we yawn? Yawning is something that everyone does — when we feel tired, bored, or even when we see someone else yawn. Scientists have studied yawning for many years, but they still do not have one clear answer. There are several popular theories (理论) that try to explain this common behavior.

② One of the oldest ideas is the "oxygen theory." People once believed that we yawn because our brain needs more oxygen. When we breathe in deeply during a yawn, we take in more air. However, later studies showed that people do not yawn more when the air has less oxygen. So this theory is not widely accepted today.

③ Another theory is that yawning helps us stay alert (清醒的). When we are tired or bored, our brain may slow down. A big yawn might wake up our brain by stretching our jaw muscles and increasing blood flow to the head. This could explain why we often yawn in the morning when we wake up or during long meetings when we feel sleepy.

④ You may have noticed that yawning seems to be "contagious" (传染的). When one person yawns, others nearby often start yawning too. Some researchers think this is related to empathy (共情). People who are better at understanding others' feelings tend to yawn more when they see someone else yawn. It might be a way our brain connects us with people around us.

⑤ Scientists are still learning about yawning. Perhaps there is no single reason — it may be a mix of many factors. Whatever the cause, yawning is a normal part of being human and something we all share.

注释： theory 理论；alert 清醒的；contagious 传染的；empathy 共情；jaw 下颌

选择题

1. According to paragraph ①, what do scientists think about yawning? A. They have several theories but no single clear answer yet. B. They have found one clear answer to why we yawn. C. They believe yawning only happens when we are bored. D. They think only humans yawn.

2. Why is the "oxygen theory" not widely accepted today? A. Because yawning has nothing to do with breathing. B. Because people do not yawn more when the air

has less oxygen. C. Because oxygen is not important for our brain. D. Because scientists have proved we get too much oxygen when we yawn.

3. According to paragraph ③, when do people often yawn? A. Right before going to bed at night. B. After eating a big meal. C. In the morning when waking up or during long boring meetings. D. When they feel very excited.

4. What can we infer from paragraph ④ about "contagious" yawning? A. Only people who lack empathy yawn when others do. B. Contagious yawning only happens between family members. C. Scientists have proved that yawning is a disease. D. Yawning might help people feel more connected with each other.

5. What is the main purpose of this passage? A. To explain different theories about why we yawn and show that it remains a puzzle. B. To tell readers to avoid yawning in public. C. To compare human yawning with animal yawning. D. To encourage people to get more sleep to reduce yawning.

详细解析

1. 【答案】A

【题型】 细节理解

【定位】 第①段 "Scientists have studied yawning for many years, but they still do not have one clear answer. There are several popular theories that try to explain this common behavior."

【解析】 原文明确指出科学家研究打哈欠多年，但仍无唯一明确答案，存在多种流行理论试图解释。A 项正确。B 项"已有唯一明确答案"与原文矛盾；C 项"只在无聊时打哈欠"过于片面；D 项"只有人类打哈欠"原文未提及。故选 A。

2. 【答案】B

【题型】 细节理解

【定位】 第②段 "later studies showed that people do not yawn more when the air has less oxygen. So this theory is not widely accepted today."

【解析】 原文说明后续研究表明空气中氧气减少时人们不会更频繁打哈欠，因此氧气理论不被广泛接受。B 项正确。A 项"与呼吸无关"过于绝对；C 项"氧气对大脑不重要"与理论本意矛盾；D 项原文未提及。故选 B。

3. 【答案】C

【题型】 细节理解

【定位】 第③段 "This could explain why we often yawn in the morning when we wake up or during long meetings when we feel sleepy."

【解析】 原文直接说明清晨起床时或漫长会议中感到困倦时常打哈欠。C 项正确。A 项"睡前"、B 项"饭后"、D 项"兴奋时"均与原文不符。故选 C。

4. 【答案】D

【题型】 推理判断

【定位】 第④段 "It might be a way our brain connects us with people around us."

【解析】 原文指出传染性打哈欠可能与共情相关，可能是大脑将我们与周围人连接的一种方式。可推知打哈欠或有助于人们彼此联系。A 项"缺乏共情的人才打哈欠"与"better at understanding others' feelings tend to yawn more"相反；B 项"仅发生在家人间"、C 项"打哈欠是疾病"原文均未提及。D 项正确。故选 D。

5. 【答案】A

【题型】 写作意图/主旨大意

【定位】 全文：第①段提出问题，第②③④段介绍多种理论，第⑤段总结仍待研究。

【解析】 全文围绕打哈欠的不同科学解释展开，并指出尚无定论，A 项"解释我们为何打哈欠的多种理论，表明这仍是一个待解之谜"准确概括写作目的。B 项"避免公共场合打哈欠"、C 项"比较人与动物"、D 项"鼓励多睡觉"均非文章重点。故选 A。